

Solve compatibility woes with Virtual PC

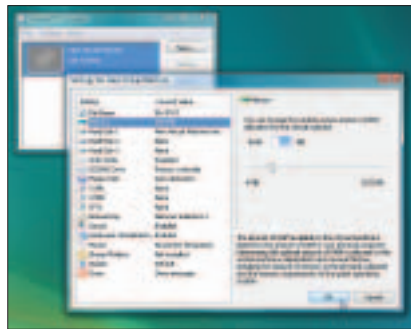
If an old program won't run under Vista, setting up a virtual XP PC is the ultimate solution

Some old programs are simply stubborn. No matter how much you play around with Compatibility Mode or administrative privileges, they just won't run under Vista. That's where Microsoft Virtual PC 2007 comes in. It lets you create a virtual Windows XP installation on your Vista system, but without any of the usual disk partitioning or dual-boot hassles. Instead, in effect, you run Windows XP as an application on your Vista desktop, then use your 'PC within a PC' to run your old programs whenever you like.

Virtual PC doesn't generally support games, and you will need a Windows XP disc and license number to create your installation. Also, you can't use a version of XP that you're using elsewhere. But if these aren't issues for you, then Virtual PC could solve your Vista compatibility issues.

Step 1

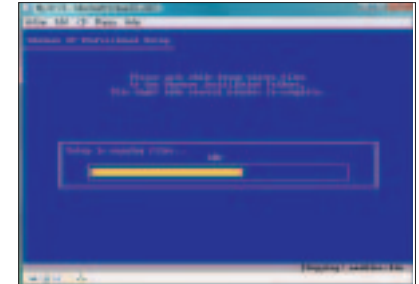
You can install Microsoft Virtual PC 2007 directly from our cover disc (or you can download it from www.microsoft.com/windows/products/winfamily/virtualpc). With no complicated setup options to consider, accept the default settings and it will install in a few moments. Launch Virtual PC and click Settings to configure your first Virtual Machine (VM). This can get complicated, as you're able to define everything from how the mouse works to the number of hard disks your XP installation will



have, but let's keep things simple. Click File Name and call this VM something like 'My XP PC', then select the Memory option and set your VM to use 256MB, or half your PC's memory — whichever is less. Click OK when you're done.

Step 2

Place your Windows XP disc into your computer's CD drive, click Start in the Virtual PC console, and a window will show your VM as it boots. Wait 30 seconds — if the Windows XP setup screen still hasn't appeared then the program probably needs a little help. Click the CD menu and choose 'Use Physical Drive D:' (or whatever drive contains your XP disc), then close the VM window and click Start. This time you should see Virtual PC boot from your Windows CD and launch the Setup program. Press Enter on your keyboard to choose the 'Set up Windows XP now' option, and work through the installation. This might feel scary, but don't worry — none of this will affect your Vista installation. Setup is running inside your VM, so your Vista settings will be untouched.



Step 3

When Setup has finished, your VM window will contain a complete Windows XP desktop. It will probably be small, but you can resize it in the normal XP way: right-click on an empty part of the desktop, select Properties > Settings and choose a larger resolution. By now you will also have noticed that the VM has 'captured' your mouse and keyboard. You're not able to move the mouse cursor away from its window to launch a Windows Vista program, and pressing the Windows key, or Ctrl

